

PRODUCT IMPROVEMENT



My LinkedIn Story

LinkedIn is my favourite platform and the one I find myself coming back to every single day. As someone working in tech and actively exploring opportunities in Product Management and Chief of Staff roles, LinkedIn feels like a platform built for people like me ambitious professionals who want to grow, connect and stay relevant in their field.

What genuinely excites me about LinkedIn is the quality of people on it. Where else can you scroll through your feed and read a post from a VP at Google, a founder who just raised a Series B, or a Chief of Staff sharing what their week actually looks like? That kind of access to real professionals sharing real experiences is something no other platform offers. It gives me a sense of what is possible and constantly pushes me to think bigger about my own career.

I also love that LinkedIn is a platform where showing ambition is celebrated. Unlike other social media platforms where professional talk can feel out of place, LinkedIn is a

space where sharing your goals, your learnings and your career journey is completely natural. Every time I open LinkedIn I discover something new a job opportunity I had not considered, a person whose journey mirrors what I am trying to do, or a piece of content that reframes how I think about my career. That sense of discovery and possibility is what keeps me coming back.

On top of that, the Jobs section is genuinely useful. Being able to search for roles, see who in my network works at a company, and apply directly from my phone makes the job search process feel far less overwhelming than it used to be.

LinkedIn is not just an app to me it is a space where I feel like I am investing in my future every time I open it.

What is LinkedIn

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform with over 1 billion members globally. Founded in 2003 and acquired by Microsoft in 2016, it connects professionals, recruiters and businesses across the world on a single platform built entirely around professional identity and growth.

Business Verticals

- Talent Solutions is the largest vertical contributing approximately 60% of total revenue, offering tools like LinkedIn Recruiter and Job Slots that help companies find, approach and hire candidates at scale.
- Premium Subscriptions is the second vertical where individuals pay for plans like Premium Career and Sales Navigator, unlocking features like InMail credits, advanced search filters and profile visibility insights.
- Marketing Solutions is the third vertical where brands pay to reach LinkedIn's high intent professional audience through sponsored content, display ads and lead generation campaigns.
- LinkedIn Learning is the fourth vertical offering thousands of online courses in business, technology and creative skills, often bundled with Premium subscription plans as a career development tool.

Competitive Landscape

LinkedIn competes with job focused platforms like Naukri, Indeed and Instahyre on job discovery and recruiter access, often at lower price points. AI powered platforms like Wellfound and Cutshort are emerging as smarter alternatives for role matching. General

AI assistants like ChatGPT and Claude are also becoming increasingly relevant in the professional growth and career guidance space.

LinkedIn's Moat

LinkedIn's professional network remains its strongest and most defensible asset — an irreplaceable graph of professional identities, work histories, endorsements and connections built over two decades that no competitor has come close to replicating. This is what makes LinkedIn the default destination for professionals globally when it comes to building their presence, finding opportunities and growing their network.

Clarifying Questions

- What kind of improvement are we targeting? → **User engagement and retention, with new user acquisition as a secondary outcome**
- Is this improvement scoped to a specific region? → **Global, with India as the primary market context**
- Are we solving for desktop or mobile? → **Mobile first**
- Are there any budget or resource constraints? → **Assume none**

Problem Statement

To improve user engagement and retention on LinkedIn's mobile app across all active markets without any budget or resource constraints.

User Segmentation

LinkedIn serves over 1 billion members globally. Rather than segmenting by demographics alone, we segment by user intent and behaviour — what each group is trying to achieve on the platform.

SEGMENT	USE CASE ON LINKEDIN	WHY THEY MATTER
Career Starters	Building their first professional profile, discovering entry level opportunities and connecting with industry professionals for guidance	Large and growing segment, high lifetime value if retained early, highly engaged when given the right direction
Career Climbers	Seeking better roles, promotions or lateral moves within their existing industry, staying updated on industry trends	Most active job seekers on the platform, directly drive Premium subscription revenue
Career Pivoters	Repositioning their profile for a new industry or role, finding the right people to connect with and consuming content relevant to their target domain	Most underserved segment today, high intent users who struggle with the platform's reactive nature, strong Premium conversion opportunity
Talent Seekers	Sourcing, evaluating and approaching candidates for open roles at their organisations	Primary drivers of Talent Solutions revenue, LinkedIn's largest revenue stream
Builders & Thought Leaders	Growing personal brand, publishing content and building influence within their professional community	Drive content quality and platform engagement, attract other users to the platform

USER PERSONAS

Persona 1: Career Starter

Name	Priya Sharma
Age	21
Location	Pune, India
Current Role	Final Year Engineering Student
Experience	0 years
Needs	Build first professional profile, discover entry level jobs, get guidance on where to start
Behaviour on LinkedIn	Applies to jobs via Easy Apply, follows company pages, connects with college alumni for referrals

Persona 2: Career Climber

Name	Rohan Mehta
Age	29

Location	Mumbai, India
Current Role	Marketing Manager
Experience	5 years
Needs	Grow within current domain, get noticed by right recruiters, build credibility and stay updated on industry trends
Behaviour on LinkedIn	Posts thought leadership content, engages with senior professionals, tracks profile views via Premium

Persona 3: Career Pivoter

Name	Arjun Nair
Age	25
Location	Bengaluru, India
Current Role	Software Developer
Experience	3 years

Needs	Reposition profile for a new role, find the right people to connect with, access relevant content and guidance for target domain
Behaviour on LinkedIn	Searches for professionals in target roles, manually updates profile, consumes domain specific content, sends connection requests to PMs and CoS professionals

Persona 4: Talent Seeker

Name	Neha Kapoor
Age	34
Location	Delhi, India
Current Role	Senior Talent Acquisition Manager
Experience	8 years
Needs	Source quality candidates quickly, reduce time to hire, build employer brand to attract passive candidates
Behaviour on LinkedIn	Uses LinkedIn Recruiter daily, sends InMails, posts about open roles and company culture

Persona 5: Builder and Thought Leader

Name	Vikram Sinha
Age	38
Location	Bengaluru, India
Current Role	Co-founder, B2B SaaS Startup
Experience	10 years
Needs	Build personal brand, grow the right professional audience, use LinkedIn as a content distribution channel
Behaviour on LinkedIn	Posts 4 to 5 times a week, engages actively in comments, tracks content analytics, runs LinkedIn newsletters

Prioritized Persona - The Professional Navigator

Combined Persona Profile

Persona Name	The Professional Navigator
Representative Users	Arjun Nair - Software Developer pivoting to PM & Priya Sharma - Final Year Student entering the workforce
Age Range	21 to 27
Location	Tier 1 Indian cities — Bengaluru, Mumbai, Pune, Delhi
Experience	0 to 3 years
Needs	Build or reposition a professional identity, discover the right people to follow and connect with, access content relevant to their target domain and get meaningful guidance on next steps
Behaviour on LinkedIn	Searching for professionals in target roles, manually updating profiles, consuming domain specific content, sending connection requests with limited success, applying to jobs with minimal response

After evaluating all five user segments, we are prioritizing a combined persona drawn from Career Starters and Career Pivoters. While these are two distinct segments, they share a fundamental overlapping need on LinkedIn both are trying to build or rebuild a

professional identity in a domain they are unfamiliar with, without any proactive guidance from the platform.

We call this combined persona **The Professional Navigator** someone who knows where they want to go professionally but does not yet have the network, the content diet or the platform signals to get there.

Rationale for Prioritization

Both Career Starters and Career Pivoters experience the sharpest gap between what LinkedIn promises and what it actually delivers. The platform's recommendations, feed and suggestions are all anchored to past behaviour actively working against users who are intentionally trying to move in a new direction. No existing LinkedIn feature is designed to support someone trying to move away from their current professional identity. This is a clear and unaddressed product gap.

Together these two segments form one of LinkedIn's largest and fastest growing user groups. Career Starters represent millions of fresh graduates entering the workforce annually while Career Pivoters represent a rapidly growing segment with nearly 46% of global professionals considering a career change. Combined they present a significant Premium conversion opportunity users actively navigating a career transition are highly motivated to pay for tools that genuinely help them, directly improving LinkedIn's Premium acquisition and retention.

Finally this persona is prioritized because the pain points are grounded in real lived experience as someone personally navigating a transition from Software Development to Product Management, the challenges of this persona are deeply understood rather than assumed.

Existing User Journey - The Professional Navigator

The following represents the typical journey of a Professional Navigator a Career Starter or Career Pivoter when they decide to pursue a new career direction on LinkedIn.

Stage 1: Trigger The user makes a decision to move into a new career direction. They open LinkedIn as their first and most natural destination to begin this journey.

Stage 2: Goal Declaration The user tries to communicate their career intent to the platform. They update their Open to Work status, set job preferences and adjust their headline to reflect their target role.

Stage 3: Profile Repositioning The user manually rewrites their About section, updates their skills and tries to reframe their experience to align with their target domain. Free users do this entirely on their own. Premium users get some AI writing assistance for their profile.

Stage 4: Network Building The user searches for professionals in their target domain, identifies people to connect with and starts sending connection requests. They also follow relevant company pages and thought leaders they come across organically.

Stage 5: Content Discovery The user begins consuming content related to their target domain to build familiarity and stay updated. They follow creators they find through search and wait for their feed to gradually shift toward relevant content.

Stage 6: Job Search The user visits the Jobs tab and searches for roles in their target domain. They review job descriptions to understand what skills and experience are expected and begin identifying roles that feel realistic to apply for.

Stage 7: Outreach and Application The user reaches out to professionals for guidance, referrals or informational conversations. They also begin submitting job applications. Free users send connection requests with notes. Premium users use InMail credits for direct outreach.

Stage 8: Evaluating Progress The user reflects on what is working how many connections accepted, how many applications submitted, how many responses received and decides whether to adjust their approach or continue on the same path.

Pain Points in the Existing User Journey

Pain Point 1: The Platform Has No Awareness of Who You Are Trying to Become

For a Career Starter like Priya, LinkedIn sees a blank slate with no professional history and no sense of where she wants to go. For a Career Pivoter like Arjun, LinkedIn continues to reflect his developer identity long after he has decided to become a Product Manager. In both cases the platform has no structured mechanism to capture career intent where the user wants to go, what role they are targeting or that they are either starting fresh or fundamentally switching direction.

What makes this worse is that even when the user begins sending new signals updating their headline, searching for different roles, engaging with new content LinkedIn's algorithm is slow to respond. The platform can take weeks to meaningfully shift its understanding of who the user is becoming. During this lag period every

recommendation, every suggested connection and every piece of content the platform surfaces continues to work against the user's transition rather than supporting it. The user is not just missing a feature they are actively fighting the platform's outdated understanding of them at every step of their journey.

Pain Point 2: Network Discovery is Random and Inefficient

When entering an unfamiliar domain, neither the Career Pivoter nor the Career Starter knows who the right people are to connect with or follow. LinkedIn's People You May Know suggestions are driven by existing network proximity not career goals. A software developer trying to break into PM has no intelligent recommendation of which PMs to reach out to, which ones are open to mentoring or which ones are most relevant to their specific transition. A fresh graduate has no network at all to draw from. Both users spend weeks sending connection requests blindly with little sense of whether they are building the right network for where they want to go.

Pain Point 3: Feed Does Not Adapt to Future Intent

LinkedIn's content algorithm is trained entirely on past behaviour and existing connections. For the Career Pivoter this means the feed continues to surface content from their old industry for weeks after they have mentally moved on. For the Career Starter whose connections are mostly college peers, the feed reflects student life rather than the professional domain they want to enter. Neither user gets a feed that reflects where they are going. Manually searching for relevant content, following new creators and engaging differently can eventually shift the algorithm but this takes weeks of sustained deliberate effort with no guarantee of results.

Pain Point 4: Profile Repositioning Lacks Intelligent Guidance

Both the Career Pivoter and Career Starter struggle to present themselves credibly for roles they have not held before. The Career Pivoter needs to reframe existing experience in a way that resonates with a new domain. The Career Starter needs to build a compelling profile from very little. LinkedIn offers no role-specific guidance on what to highlight, what keywords matter or how recruiters in a target domain actually evaluate profiles. While LinkedIn Premium offers some AI writing assistance it optimises for existing experience not for a target role the user has not yet held.

Pain Point 5: No Transition Progress Visibility

Once both users begin their journey on LinkedIn there is no way to measure how far they have come or what to do next. There is no skills gap indicator against a target role, no milestone system that acknowledges progress and no next step recommendation

from the platform. The Career Pivoter does not know if their profile is landing differently than it was three weeks ago. The Career Starter does not know if they are building the right foundation. Both are navigating their transition entirely without feedback from the platform that holds all the relevant data to help them.

Pain Point Prioritization

Pain Point	Frequency (1-5)	Severity (1-5)	Total Score (10)	Rank
Platform Has No Awareness of Who You Are Trying to Become	5	4	9	1
Network Discovery is Random and Inefficient	5	4	9	2
Feed Does Not Adapt to Future Intent	4	4	8	3
Profile Repositioning Lacks Intelligent Guidance	3	4	7	4
No Transition Progress Visibility	3	3	6	5

Prioritized Pain Point: The Platform Has No Awareness of Who You Are Trying to Become

For a Career Starter entering the workforce for the first time, LinkedIn offers no way to say this is the kind of professional I am trying to become, help me get there. For a Career Pivoter switching domains, LinkedIn offers no way to say I am leaving this identity behind and building a new one, acknowledge that and adapt accordingly. In both cases the platform has no structured mechanism to capture future professional intent.

Even when users begin sending new signals through their behaviour, LinkedIn's algorithm takes weeks to respond meaningfully. During this period every job recommendation, network suggestion and piece of content continues to reflect the old identity making the user feel like the platform is working against them rather than with them.

Why This is the Prioritized Pain Point

While Network Discovery is equally scored at Rank 2, Platform Awareness is chosen as the primary focus for one clear reason it is the root cause that makes every other pain point exist. Network Discovery is random because LinkedIn does not know your intent. The feed does not adapt because LinkedIn does not know your direction. Profile guidance is generic because LinkedIn does not know your target role. Solving Platform Awareness first creates the foundational intelligence that can fix all downstream problems as a natural consequence. It is the highest leverage intervention available.

SOLUTIONS

Solution 1: Career Status Indicator (Quick Win)

Introduce two new career status modes on the LinkedIn profile **"Career Transitioning"** and **"Early in Career"** sitting alongside the existing Open to Work and Hiring signals. When activated, these statuses tell LinkedIn that the user's professional identity is in flux and that recommendations, feed and network suggestions should begin adapting toward their declared target direction. This is visible to the user's network, signalling openness to guidance and mentorship from professionals in their target domain.

Solution 2: Career Transition Onboarding Flow (Quick Win)

When a user activates a transitioning or early career status, LinkedIn triggers a structured onboarding flow a short guided setup asking where the user is coming from, what role or domain they are targeting and what their timeline looks like. The answers feed directly into LinkedIn's recommendation engine, giving the platform the intent signals it needs to immediately begin personalising the experience. This works for both the Career Pivoter redefining their direction and the Career Starter building their identity from scratch.

Solution 3: Skills Gap Analyzer Against Target Role (Medium Bet)

A feature where the user selects a target role and LinkedIn compares their current profile against the typical profile of professionals successfully working in that role. It identifies transferable skills worth highlighting, surfaces skills gaps that need to be addressed and recommends specific LinkedIn Learning courses to bridge those gaps. For the Career Pivoter this reframes existing experience as an asset. For the Career Starter it creates a clear roadmap of what to build toward.

Solution 4: Smart Network Recommendations for Target Domain (Medium Bet)

Instead of recommending connections based on existing network proximity, LinkedIn recommends professionals specifically relevant to the user's declared target domain. The recommendations filter for professionals who are active on the platform, have engaged with career transition content and are likely to be approachable. This gives both the Career Pivoter and Career Starter a curated, intelligent starting point for building the right network rather than searching blindly.

Solution 5: AI Career Intent Mode (Big Bet)

A conversational AI feature available as a Premium offering with a free trial period where the user describes their current state and future goal in natural language. The AI interprets this intent and simultaneously reconfigures the entire LinkedIn experience feed, job recommendations, network suggestions, content discovery and profile guidance all shift to reflect what the user has communicated. Unlike the other solutions which address individual touchpoints, the AI Intent Mode is the umbrella solution that powers everything else at once. The user can toggle between their standard LinkedIn experience and the AI Intent Mode at any time, giving them full control over how the platform understands and serves them.

Relationship Between Solutions

These solutions are not independent of each other. The Career Status Indicator and Transition Onboarding Flow are the entry points they capture intent at the surface level.

The Skills Gap Analyzer and Smart Network Recommendations are the outputs they deliver personalised value based on that intent. The AI Intent Mode is the engine that powers all of this at its most sophisticated level, capturing richer and more nuanced intent than any form or toggle can and translating it into a fully personalised LinkedIn experience.

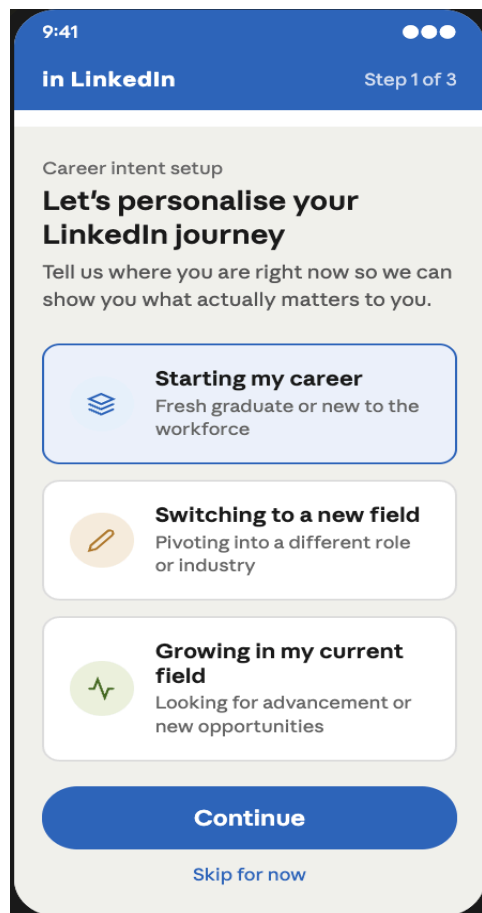
SOLUTIONS PRIORTIZATION

Solution	Impact	Effort	Priortized
Career Transition Onboarding Flow	High	Low	Yes
Smart Network Recommendations	High	Medium	Yes
AI Career Intent Mode	High	High	Yes
Skills Gap Analyzer	Medium	Medium	No
Career Status Indicator	Medium	Low	No

Top Prioritized Solutions:

1. **Career Transition Onboarding Flow** – High impact, low effort. Captures user intent immediately and feeds it into LinkedIn's recommendation engine. Fastest to ship and strongest foundation for everything else.
2. **Smart Network Recommendations** – High impact, medium effort. Uses declared intent signals to recommend the right professionals for the user's target domain. Directly solves random and inefficient network discovery.
3. **AI Career Intent Mode** – High impact, high effort. The long term umbrella solution where the user describes their career goal to an AI and LinkedIn reconfigures the entire experience accordingly. The above two solutions build toward and feed into this.

Prototype For Career Transition Onboarding Flow



Captures career intent at the right moment -

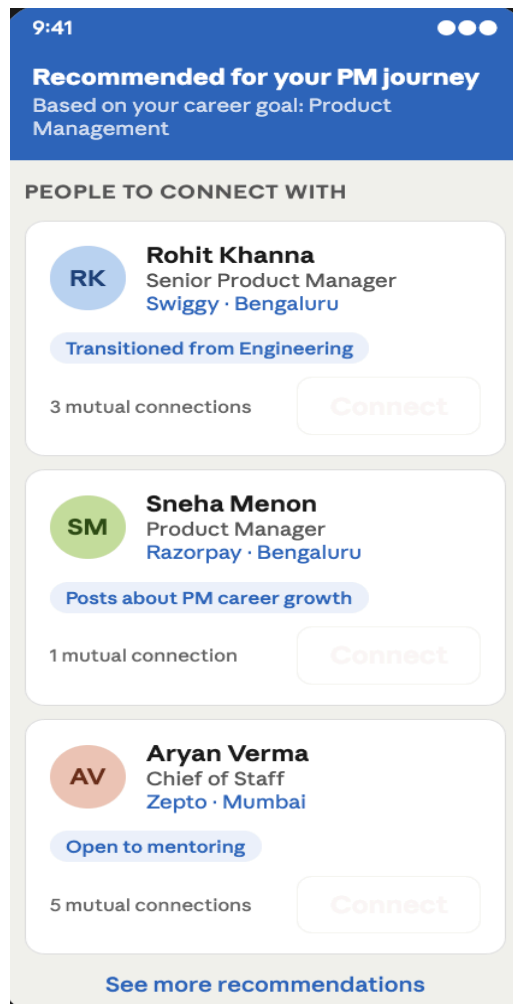
Users declare their current career phase upfront, giving LinkedIn the foundational signal it needs to personalise the entire experience immediately

Zero friction setup – Three simple options cover the full spectrum of the Professional Navigator's situation, requiring minimal effort from the user

Reduces algorithm lag – Instead of waiting weeks for the platform to infer a career shift from behaviour, the user's intent is registered instantly and recommendations adapt from day one

Inclusive for both personas – Covers Career Starters entering the workforce and Career Pivoters switching domains within the same flow

Prototype For Smart Network Recommendations



Goal-based discovery replaces proximity-based suggestions –

Recommendations are driven by the user's declared career target, not by who their existing connections know

Relevance tags add context – Labels like "Transitioned from Engineering" and "Open to mentoring" help the user make informed decisions about who to reach out to

Increases outreach quality – Connecting with the right people from the start improves the likelihood of meaningful responses and genuine career guidance

Directly addresses the root pain point – Eliminates the randomness and inefficiency of network building for someone entering an unfamiliar domain

Prototype For AI Career Intent Mode

9:41

What role are you working towards?
We'll personalise your LinkedIn instantly

Select your target roles
Choose one or more roles

Search for a role...

Product Manager

Chief of Staff

UX Designer

Data Analyst + More

Describe what you're looking for
More context = better personalisation

Software developer with 3 years exp, looking to move into PM at early stage startups or fintech.

98 / 300

Personalise my LinkedIn

Screen 1 - Input

9:41

Your LinkedIn is ready
Personalised for your career goals

✓

All done!
Your experience has been updated based on your goals

● **Feed updated** ✓

● **Jobs tailored** ✓

● **Network recommended** ✓

Explore my new LinkedIn

Screen 2 - Confirmation

Multi-role selection – Users can select one or more target roles simultaneously, making the feature useful for someone exploring multiple career directions at once

Free text description adds depth – The description box allows users to provide richer context their background, preferred industry, company stage enabling more precise personalisation beyond just a job title

Search input reduces friction – Users who do not see their target role in the suggestions can search for any role, making the feature inclusive across all career paths

Instant confirmation builds trust – Users see exactly what changed feed, jobs and network the moment they hit personalise, with updates reflecting the specific context they provided

METRICS

NORTH STAR METRIC:

Career Transition Success Rate - The percentage of Professional Navigators who successfully move into their target role within 6 months of activating the career intent feature on LinkedIn.

This is the right North Star because it captures the ultimate outcome we are solving for. Everything we built the onboarding flow, smart network recommendations and AI intent mode exists to help this user successfully transition. If this number moves, everything is working. If it does not, something in the journey is still broke

SUPPORTING METRICS:

Career Intent Feature Activation Rate - of users who activate the onboarding flow or AI intent mode

Feed Relevance Score - % of content interactions on target domain content post-activation

Network Quality Score - % of connection requests to target domain professionals that result in a conversation

Job Application to Interview Rate - % of applications to target role jobs that result in recruiter responses

Premium Retention Rate - % of Professional Navigators retaining Premium after 3 months

Time to First Relevant Connection - Average days to make first meaningful connection in target domain after activation

Weekly Active Usage Post Activation - % of users remaining weekly active 4 weeks after activating career intent features

GUARDRAIL METRICS (What We Must Not Break)

- Overall LinkedIn DAU should not drop as a result of feed changes

- InMail response rates should not decline for Talent Seekers as network recommendations scale
- Premium churn rate should not increase during the trial to paid conversion window

SUMMARY

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional network but it is built around who you are, not who you are trying to become. For the Professional Navigator a Career Starter or Career Pivoter this creates a fundamental disconnect where the platform's feed, job recommendations and network suggestions all work against the user's transition rather than supporting it.

To solve this we propose three solutions in order of priority. The Career Transition Onboarding Flow captures user intent immediately and eliminates algorithm lag. Smart Network Recommendations surfaces the right professionals based on career goals rather than existing connections. The AI Career Intent Mode allows users to declare their target roles and describe their goals in their own words, instantly personalising their entire LinkedIn experience in one step.

Together these solutions turn LinkedIn from a record of the past into a guide toward the future improving engagement, Premium retention and most importantly, helping Professional Navigators actually get where they are trying to go.